Guruswami Aiyar tried valiantly to secure some justice for the company by appealing to the sense of British fair play. Distancing the company from VOC, he raised the issue of partiality in the executive's dealings with SSNCo by marshalling a wide range of supporting evidence.

Governor Lawley responded somewhat disingenuously, 'Are you trying to argue that the Government and Government officials are tilting against the Swadeshi Company?' Guruswami Aiyar replied politely, 'That is the fear of the people in Tinnevelly'—a fear shared by people across the presidency. The BI had the ears of the local authorities and had sold the idea that SSNCo was 'an objectionable company', i.e. anti-British. When a local official acted in a partial manner, the common public believed that he had the sanction of the government—a view which, Guruswami Aiyar argued, should be dispelled. He then provided various instances, many of them noted above, where the administration had acted in a manner inimical to the company's legitimate interests. The governor, members of his council and the chief secretary, hastily and even impatiently, countered his argument and brushed aside every example that he cited.

For instance, when Guruswami Aiyar mentioned Sankara Subbu Aiyar's arrest as being without cause, the governor retorted by asking why he did not protest. When Guruswami Aiyar replied that since he was let out and there was no information on the identity of the complainant, the governor, feigning helplessness, asked what could the government do if no complaint was lodged. When a startled Guruswami Aiyar responded, 'A man who gets Rs 10, is he expected to take steps?' he had to face a gubernatorial retort: 'There are his employers' who could have lodged a complaint on their behalf—indicating clearly who the government's target was. Guruswami Aiyar could only mumble the reply: 'We cannot spend money on that. We do not want officials to disfavour the company.'[39]

Even an open-and-shut case such as the intimidation of the SSNCo's clerk by Ashe, demanding the inspection of the share register, was brushed aside by the governor stating that he did not infer anything wrong from it. Contending that everything was hearsay, Lawley said that the government could not initiate any inquiry unless a formal complaint was made.